out like that in front of my home supporters while I was in such great form was particularly galling.

'If' I had batted out that whole day, I am confident I would have got to 250. It was a tough call for me, especially as I was having one of those 'in the zone' days, where I felt invincible – Graeme Smith and I put on 368 for the opening partnership. Ja, Venkat was never my favourite man behind the stumps, but thems the breaks, I guess. Still, I did score 228 – not too bad – and it remains my highest Test score.

I was also disappointed not to get a century against the Aussies in Australia and also on the subcontinent. I came so flipping close too. During the second Test at the MCG in Melbourne in 2005 I was on 94 when Andrew Symonds – of all people – got me with a medium-pacer. He was bowling with the new ball, and he got one delivery to bounce a little, which came off my elbow and went onto the stumps. I got a few 90s on the subcontinent – 98 against Pakistan at Faisalabad in 2003, and 92 against Sri Lanka at Colombo in 2006, but I never got that elusive 100.

In terms of my Test career, then, I'm more than happy to have got as many as 90 Test caps, but there are those three disappointments: not getting to 250 in an innings, and not scoring centuries in Australia or on the subcontinent. They do linger with me.

I've still got a couple of goals, though …

Presuming I remain injury free and in good enough nick, I would like to continue my cricket career for another four to five years. I see no reason why I can't carry on until I'm 40. Look at old Sanath Jayasuriya – the Sri Lankan legend is 41 and played for Sri Lanka in the 2010 T20 World Cup in the West Indies. And what about Adam Gilchrist and Matthew Hayden? Both are approaching 40, and they're still very influential in the IPL. I think, particularly in 20-over cricket, you can easily play until that age if you're in shape.

Actually, the biggest issue in the longevity of one's career is mental and not physical. A 20-over game is only three hours long, so that's not a problem. The problem starts when you're playing in 20-over tournaments like the IPL, *and* you're still involved in international Test and ODI cricket. That's a pretty hectic schedule, and competing at such a high level of intensity week in and week out can be mentally exhausting.